

CREATIVE iMEDIA



INCLUDED ON THE
KS4 PERFORMANCE TABLES

Specification

Cambridge OCR Level 1/Level 2

Cambridge National in
**Creative
iMedia**

J834

Version 6 (First teaching September 2022)

ocr.org.uk/cambridgenationals





About our new name

As of September 2025, our name is Cambridge OCR.

Students who sat an exam **in summer 2025** will receive a Cambridge OCR branded exam certificate (our new brand), which will be the same for all future exam series.

You'll continue to see the OCR or Oxford Cambridge and RSA Examinations name while we work to update our material to our new name, Cambridge OCR. This will take some time, and you can still access all up-to-date qualification resources and materials via [Teach Cambridge](#).

Important: We'll keep the OCR/Oxford Cambridge and RSA name on existing teaching resources while the content of these remains applicable to the specification being taught. **New and refreshed** resources will be produced using the Cambridge OCR name/logo.

Are you using the latest version of this specification?

The latest version of our specifications will always be on [our website](#) and may differ from printed versions. We will inform centres about changes to specifications.

Tell us what you think

Your feedback plays an important role in how we develop, market, support and resource qualifications now and into the future. We want you and your students to enjoy and get the best out of our qualifications and resources, but to do that we need your honest opinions to tell us whether we're on the right track or not.

You can email your thoughts to support@ocr.org.uk or visit our [feedback page](#) to learn more about how you can help us improve our qualifications.



Designing and testing in [collaboration with teachers](#) and students



Helping young people develop an [ethical view of the world](#)



Equality, diversity, inclusion and belonging (EDIB) are [part of everything we do](#)

Qualification overview Section 6.1.1: Centre and teacher/ assessor responsibilities Section 6.2: Requirements and guidance for delivering and marking the OCR-set assignments Section 6.3: Feedback Section 6.4.4: Reattempting work before submitting marks to OCR	Updated to clarify information relating to NEA resubmissions.	Version 2 (May 2022)
Section 6.5: Moderating NEA units	Updated information on how to submit moderated units.	
Section 6.6: Resubmitting moderated work to OCR to improve the grade Section 6.7: Recording feedback and decisions	New sections added to clarify information relating to NEA resubmissions.	
Section 7: Administration	Updated information to clarify administrative arrangements.	
Appendix A: Guidance for the production of electronic evidence	Updated information related to 'Submit for Assessment'.	
All	Weblinks updated.	
Section 2.1: Qualification overview	Updated to clarify information relating to Availability and Assessment method/model.	Version 3 (August 2023)
Section 3.2: Language	Updated to clarify this qualification is available in English only and all candidate work must be in English.	
Section 3.3: Availability	New section added to clarify qualification is not available in Wales or Northern Ireland.	
Section 6.1.1 Centre and teacher/ assessor responsibilities	Updated to clarify information relating to the availability of sample assessment material for practice purposes.	
Section 6.1.1 Centre and teacher/ assessor responsibilities Section 6.2 Requirements and guidance for delivering and marking the OCR set assignments. Section 6.2.1 Ways to authenticate work Section 6.2.2 Plagiarism	Updated to include information relating to AI Use in Assessments	
Section 6.2 Requirements and guidance for delivering and marking the OCR set assignments	Updated to clarify information relating to availability of live assignments and making entries.	
Section 7.5.2 Making final unit entries	Updated to clarify information about making unit entries.	
Appendix A	Updated standard file formats table	

2.1 Qualification at a glance	Updated information on terminal assessment and exam resits	Version 4 May 2024
4.1.1 Terminal Assessment Rule	New section added to provide information on the terminal assessment rule	
5.1 Overview of the assessment	Updated to clarify the terminal rule	
6.3.7 Presentation of the final piece of work	Updated information on submission of work for moderation	
7.2 Collecting evidence of student performance to ensure resilience in the qualifications system	New section added to provide information on collecting evidence of student performance to ensure resilience in the qualifications system	
7.3 Entry rules, including Terminal Assessment	Updated to clarify information relating to entry rules and terminal assessment	
7.6 Making final entries	Updated to clarify use of component codes and digital submission of work for moderation	
All	Updated information to ensure compliance with new JCQ requirements and guidance.	Version 5 (September 2025)
All	References to 'Command words' have been replaced with 'Command and/or descriptor words', to cover both types of assessments. These are now called Descriptor Words for NEA units.	
Section 2	Included the lifespan for each set assignment and that live dates are shown on the front cover.	
Section 6	Improved clarity and guidance on: • use of the set assignment. • providing feedback to students. • resubmitting moderated work. Additional information provided to support the delivering and assessing of NEA units in line with JCQ instructions and guidance.	
Covers and all page footers	Updated to reflect the new Cambridge OCR brand. Inside cover includes statement: 'About our new name'.	
Throughout	Hyperlinks refreshed The following forms are now only available on Teach Cambridge : unit recording sheets (URS) and set assignment feedback form	Version 6 (June 2026)
Section 4.8 Unit R099: Digital games	Updated Task 2 Assessment guidance to clarify the format of the evidence accepted	
Section 5.4 Grading and awarding grades	Updated to clarify on results day a marks calculator will be published for the specific series	
Section 6.1.1 Centre and teacher/ assessor responsibilities	Updated name of online training module and information about centre approval	
Section 6.2.2 Plagiarism (including AI misuse)	Updated to include more information relating to AI misuse in assessments and required teaching for referencing or acknowledging material copied from the internet or other sources	
Section 6.3 Feedback	Add new section: <i>Informing students of their marks</i>	

Section 6.6 Resubmitting moderated work to us to improve the grade	Updated to clarify information relating to using work from a previous year's assignment	
Section 7.9 Post-results services	Updated access to scripts, which is a free service for exams officers to download copies of students' completed question papers	

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1 Why choose OCR?

Choose OCR and you've got the reassurance that you're working with one of the UK's leading exam boards. We have developed our specifications in consultation with teachers, employers and subject experts to provide students with a qualification that's relevant to them and meets their needs.

We're part of Cambridge University Press & Assessment. We help millions of people worldwide unlock their potential. Our qualifications, assessments, academic publications and original research spread knowledge, spark curiosity and aid understanding around the world.

We work with teachers, employers, and universities to create qualifications that support the needs of all students and help them prepare for their future. We offer A Levels, GCSEs, vocational qualifications, and other academic options to schools, colleges, workplaces, and other organisations.

1.1 Our specifications

We believe in developing specifications that help you bring the subject to life and inspire your students to achieve more. We've created teacher-friendly specifications based on extensive research and

engagement with the teaching community. They're designed to be straightforward and accessible so that you can tailor the delivery of the course to suit your needs.

1.2 Our support

We have a range of support services to help you at every stage, from preparation to delivery.

- A wide range of high-quality creative resources including resources created by leading organisations within the industry
- Textbooks and teaching and learning resources from leading publishers. For more information about all the published support for the Cambridge Nationals that has been endorsed by OCR please go to the [Cambridge Nationals page](#) on our website
- Professional development for teachers to fulfil a range of needs. To join our training (either face-to-face or online) or to search for training materials, please go to the [Professional Development page](#) on our website
- [Active Results](#) is our free results analysis service to help you review the performance of individual students or whole schools
- [ExamBuilder](#) is our free question-building platform that helps you to build your own tests using past OCR exam questions
- OCR subject advisors provide information and support to centres including specification and non examined assessment advice, updates on resources developments and a range of training opportunities. They work with subject communities through a range of networks to share ideas and expertise to support teachers

Further help and support

Whether you are new to OCR or already teaching with us, you can find useful information, help and support on our [website](#). Or get in touch:

support@ocr.org.uk

@ocrexams

01223 553998

1.3 Aims and learning outcomes

Our Cambridge National in Creative iMedia will encourage students to:

- understand and apply the fundamental principles and concepts of digital media including factors that influence product design, use of media codes and conventions, pre-production planning techniques, legal issues and creation/publishing/distribution considerations
- develop learning and practical skills that can be applied to real-life contexts and work situations
- think creatively, innovatively, analytically, logically and critically
- develop independence and confidence in using skills that would be relevant to the media industry and more widely
- design, plan, create and review digital media products which are fit for purpose meeting both client and target audience requirements.

1.4 What are the key features of this specification?

The key features of OCR's Cambridge National in Creative iMedia for you and your students are:

- a simple and intuitive assessment model, consisting of an externally assessed unit that focusses on knowledge and understanding and six skills-based, non examined assessment units (NEA)
 - a specification developed with teachers specifically for teachers. The specification lays out the subject content clearly
 - a flexible support package formed after listening to teachers' needs. The support package will help teachers to easily understand the requirements of the qualification and how it is assessed by a team of OCR Subject Advisors who support teachers directly and manage the qualification nationally
 - a specification has been designed so that students can progress onto Level 2 and Level 3 vocational qualifications including Cambridge Technicals in Digital Media and Information Technology, A Levels, T Levels or apprenticeships.
- This qualification will help students to develop:
- an understanding of media codes and conventions which can be appropriately applied when producing digital media products
 - skills used to design, plan and create digital media products that are appropriate for defined target audiences and meet client requirements.

All Cambridge Nationals qualifications offered by OCR are regulated by Ofqual, the Regulator for qualifications offered in England. The qualification number for OCR's Cambridge National in Creative iMedia is QN 603/7090/7.

2 Qualification overview

2.1 OCR Level 1/Level 2 Cambridge National in Creative iMedia at a glance

Qualification number	603/7090/7	OCR Entry code	J834
First entry date	01/09/2022	Approved age range	14-16
Guided learning hours (GLH)	120	Performance information	We've designed this qualification to meet the Department for Education (DfE) requirements for qualifications in the Technical Award category of the 14-16 performance tables
Total qualification time (TQT)	155		
Offered in	England only	Eligible for funding	It's designed to meet the funding requirements of a 14-16 study programme.
This qualification is suitable for students	• Aged 14-16 on a full-time study programme wanting to develop applied knowledge and practical skills suitable for use within the media industry. • Who want to progress onto other related study, such as vocational qualifications in digital media and information technology, A Levels, T Levels and apprenticeships. • As it is designed to meet the Department for Education's characteristics for a Technical Award.		
Entry requirements	There is no requirement for students to achieve any specific qualifications before taking this qualification.		
Qualification requirements	Students must complete three units: • one externally assessed unit (exam) - see the Terminal assessment below • two centre-assessed units (NEA)		
Assessment method/model	Unit R093 is assessed by an exam and marked by us. You will assess the NEA units and we will moderate them. We provide set assignments which must be used to assess the NEA units. Each set assignment will be valid for 1 year. The dates for which they are live are shown on the front cover. You must make sure you use the live assignment for students' assessments and submit in the period in which it is live. You must make sure students have an entry for each series in which you intend to submit or resubmit an NEA unit.		
Assessment series each year	• January • June		
Terminal assessment	The exam must be taken in the final assessment series before qualification certification. If a student retakes their qualification, they will need to resit the exam in order to meet the terminal rule again. The first qualification grade is used for school performance tables even if they have improved their qualification grade.		
Grading	All results are awarded on the following scale: Level 2 – Distinction* (*2), Distinction (D2), Merit (M2), Pass (P2) Level 1 – Distinction (D1), Merit (M1), Pass (P1) and Fail/Unclassified.		
Exam resits	Students can resit the exam. The terminal assessment rule means that the resit result will be used towards the student's final qualification grade and not the best result.		

Repeat submission of students' NEA work

If students have not performed at their best during the assessment of NEA units, they can improve their work and submit it to you again for assessment. They must have your agreement and you must be sure it is in the student's best interests.

We use the term 'resubmission' when referring to student work that has previously been submitted to OCR for moderation. Following OCR moderation a student can attempt to improve their work, for you to assess and provide the final mark to us. There is one resubmission opportunity per NEA assignment.

All work submitted (or resubmitted) must be based on the assignment that is live for the series of submission.

For information about feedback see [section 6](#). The final piece of work must be completed solely by the student and teachers must not detail specifically what amendments should be made.

2.2 Qualification structure

For this qualification, students must achieve **three** units: one externally assessed and two Non Examined Assessment (NEA) units.

Key to units for this qualification:

M = Mandatory	Students must achieve this unit
O = Optional	Students must achieve one of these units
E = External assessment	We set and mark the exam
N = NEA	You assess this and we moderate it

Unit no.	Unit title	Unit ref. no. (URN)	Guided learning hours (GLH)	How are they assessed?	Mandatory or optional
R093	Creative iMedia in the media industry	K/618/5870	48	E	M
R094	Visual identity and digital graphics	M/618/5871	30	NEA	M
R095	Characters and comics	T/618/5872	42	NEA	O
R096	Animation with audio	A/618/5873	42	NEA	O
R097	Interactive digital media	F/618/5874	42	NEA	O
R098	Visual imaging	J/618/5875	42	NEA	O
R099	Digital games	L/618/5876	42	NEA	O

2.3 Purpose statement



OCR Level 1/Level 2 Cambridge National in Creative iMedia

Qualification number: 603/7090/7

Type of qualification: Technical Award

Overview

Who is this qualification for?

The Level 1/Level 2 Cambridge National in Creative iMedia is aimed at students aged 14-16 years and will develop knowledge, understanding and practical skills that would be used in the media industry.

You may be interested in this if you want an engaging qualification where you will use your learning in practical, real-life situations, such as:

- developing visual identities for clients
- planning and creating original digital graphics
- planning, creating and reviewing original digital media products.

This will help you to develop independence and confidence in using skills that would be relevant to the media industry.

The qualification will also help you to develop learning and skills that can be used in other life and work situations, such as:

- thinking about situations and deciding what is required to be successful
- exploring different options and choosing the best way forward to solve a problem
- exploring and generating original ideas to find imaginative solutions to problems
- selecting the best tools and techniques to use to solve a problem

- appropriate use of media to convey meaning
- use of planning techniques to complete tasks in an organised way which meet deadlines.

This qualification will complement other learning that you are completing for GCSEs or vocational qualifications at Key Stage 4 and help to prepare you for further study. More information about this is given below.

What will you study as part of the qualification?

You will study 2 mandatory units and choose 1 optional unit.

The two mandatory units are:

- Unit R093: Creative iMedia in the media industry

This is assessed by taking an exam.

In this unit you will learn about the media industry, digital media products, how they are planned, and the media codes which are used to convey meaning, create impact and engage audiences. Topics include:

- The media industry
- Factors influencing product design
- Pre-production planning
- Distribution considerations

- Unit R094: Visual identity and digital graphics

This is assessed by completing a set assignment.

In this unit you will learn how to develop visual identities for clients and use the concepts of graphic design to create original digital graphics to engage target audiences. Topics include:

- Develop visual identity
- Plan digital graphics for products
- Create visual identity and digital graphics

There are 5 optional units to choose from. Each optional unit has the same structure to your learning, but the conventions and practical skills are tailored to the media product being studied.

The 5 optional units are:

- Unit R095: Characters and comics

This is assessed by completing a set assignment.

In this unit you will learn how to plan, create and review comics which contain original characters. Topics include:

- Plan characters and comics
- Create characters and comics
- Review characters and comics

- Unit R096: Animation and audio

This is assessed by completing a set assignment

In this unit you will learn how to plan, create and review animation with an audio soundtrack.

Topics include:

- Plan animation with audio
- Create animation with audio
- Review animation with audio

- Unit R097: Interactive digital media

This is assessed by completing a set assignment.

In this unit you will learn how to plan, create and review interactive digital media products.

Topics include:

- Plan interactive digital media
- Create interactive digital media
- Review interactive digital media

- Unit R098: Visual imaging

This is assessed by completing a set assignment.

In this unit you will learn how to plan, create and review portfolios of visual imagery. Topics include:

- Plan visual imaging portfolios
- Create visual imaging portfolios
- Review visual imaging portfolios

- Unit R099: Digital games

This is assessed by completing a set assignment.

In this unit you will learn how to plan, create and review digital games. Topics include:

- Plan digital games
- Create digital games
- Review digital games

What knowledge and skills will you develop as part of this qualification and how might these be of use and value in further studies?

The media industry is vast, covering different sectors and providing work for freelance creatives as well as large teams in design houses and multinational companies. But there are common aspects to all digital media products. This qualification will help you to develop knowledge, and understanding relating to different sectors, products and job roles that form the media industry. You will learn how media codes and conventions are applied to create digital media products which engage audiences. You will also learn the purpose of, and reasons for legislation applicable to the media industry and what media producers must do to comply with this legislation. In addition, you will gain an understanding of the properties and formats of media files.

Visual identity is a vital component of any business, product or brand. It makes a brand recognisable and helps sell a product or idea to a target audience. In this qualification you will learn how to develop visual identities for clients and apply the concepts of graphic design to create original digital graphics to engage target audiences.

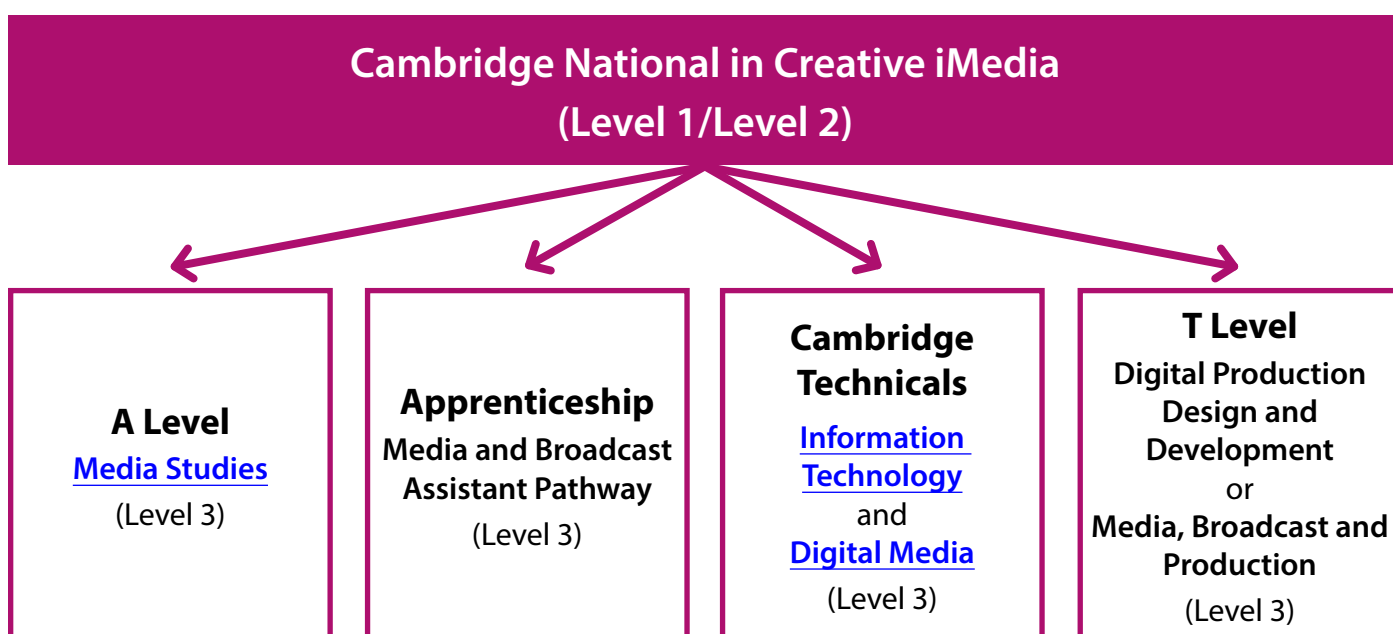
You can choose one unit from a number of optional units. Each of these units will help you develop understanding and skills related to different digital media products from a number of sectors of the media industry including:

- designing and creating comic characters that convey emotion and personality – the skills developed are relevant to illustration, graphic design and character design

- planning animations with audio based on client briefs – gaming technologies, mobile phones, the film industry and multimedia websites all use digital animation to enhance applications, entertain and inform the viewer
- using digital camera equipment to plan and capture photographs and video footage, edit images and produce effective portfolios in response to a client brief – static and moving images are used in the media industry for products as diverse as print publishing, news/journalism, advertisements, movies and interactive media.

The knowledge and skills you develop will help you to progress onto further study in the media industry. This may be other vocational qualifications including the Level 2 or Level 3 OCR Cambridge Technicals in Digital Media and/or Information Technology; the T Level Qualification in Digital Production Design and Development or Media, Broadcast and Production; or the Media and Broadcast Assistant Pathway Apprenticeship. The qualification also helps to develop other transferable skills including creative thinking, digital presentation, planning and problem solving that will be valuable in other life and work situations.

The diagram below shows the possible progression routes for your further study:



Which subjects will complement this course?

- OCR Level 1/Level 2 Cambridge National in IT
- OCR Level 1/Level 2 Cambridge National in Enterprise and Marketing
- GCSE Art and Design
- GCSE Computer Science
- GCSE Media Studies
- GCSE Business Studies

Further details

- [Specification](#)
- [Sample Assessment Material \(SAM\)](#)
- [Guide to our Sample Assessment Material](#)
- [Student guide to NEA assignments](#)

3 About this qualification

3.1 Qualification size (GLH and TQT)

The size of the qualification is described in terms of Guided Learning Hours (GLH) and Total Qualification Time (TQT).

GLH indicates the approximate time (in hours) the teacher will spend supervising or directing study and assessment activities. We have worked with people who are experienced in delivering related qualifications to determine the content that needs to be taught and how long it will take to deliver.

TQT includes two parts:

- GLH
- an estimate of the number of hours a student will spend on unsupervised learning or assessment activities (including homework) to successfully achieve their qualification.

OCR Level 1/Level 2 Cambridge National in Creative iMedia is 120 GLH and 155 TQT.

3.2 Language

This qualification is available in English only. All assessment materials are available in English only and all candidate work must be in English.

3.3 Availability

The Cambridge Nationals qualifications are available in England. They are **not** available in Wales or Northern Ireland.

3.4 Performance information

We've designed this qualification to meet the Department for Education (DfE) requirements for qualifications in the Technical Award category of the 14-16 performance tables.

You'll find information on performance tables for England on the Department for Education [website](#).

4 Units

4.1 Guidance on unit content

This section describes what must be taught so that students can access all available marks.